

Boston Sunday Globe

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FEBRUARY 1, 2026

On campus, a dwindling presence: male students

Widening gender gap has colleges revising appeals

By Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

BURLINGTON, Vt. — The American university, already tiptoeing under the reproachful eye of the Trump administration and struggling to respond to the ongoing student debt crisis, is also facing a stealthy but potentially seismic change that would have ripple effects beyond campus into the US economy and society in general.

Fewer men are going to college.

A gender gap in enrollment that had tilted toward women for decades has widened to the point where at dozens of campuses in New England, males now make up less than 40 percent of the student population.

While the gap in part reflects the tremendous progress women have made in recent decades, it also raises big questions about the long-term earnings potential of men and the effect that could have on the US economy, as well as more personal issues involving the well-being and confidence of young men. The result of all that, said Michael Kimmel, a retired professor of sociology and gender studies at Stony Brook University who special-

MALE STUDENTS, Page A9

A town-gown showdown over money

Some schools are resisting city’s pressure to pay up

By Diti Kohli, Catherine Carlock, and Neena Hagen
GLOBE STAFF

In fall 2025, Boston City Hall made an unprecedented ask of Northeastern University: \$10 million.

City negotiators were trying to get the school — a nonprofit exempt from most property taxes — to increase the amount it pays into city coffers five-fold, up from \$1.9 million a year, a source close to the negotiations said.

Their request was not without reason: Northeastern’s explosive growth in the last quarter century has helped transform Roxbury into a pricier neighborhood, sparking fears that longtime residents would be pushed out. Now the school was back at City Hall seeking permission to expand through a once-a-decade update to its master plan.

The \$10 million ask was not a quid pro quo, but city officials knew their circumstances. Private real estate development that long buoyed the Boston budget has dried up, and the city needs new ways

UNIVERSITIES, Page B3

‘I am personally so saddened. Generations of Greenlandic children are going to grow up and not trust America.’

TILLIE MARTINUSSEN, a former member of Greenlandic Parliament



With about 20,000 residents, Nuuk, Greenland’s capital, has the feel of a city. You can walk most of it in 20 minutes.

We went to Greenland to tell a very serious story.

Then we met a Trump impersonator licking an iceberg.

STORY BY EMMA PLATOFF
PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI
GLOBE STAFF

NUUP KANGERLUA, Greenland — The Donald Trump impersonator is driving the boat.

Behind him is Qoornup Sullua, the deep, frigid strait that leads 30 miles back to Greenland’s capital city, Nuuk. To his right, a snow-topped mountain 5,000 feet high — Qingaq in Greenlandic, for “nose.” We are in one of the world’s largest fjords, the most beautiful, hostile landscape any of us is likely to ever see. Yet all eyes are on the man with the orange makeup and the sealskin jacket — now steering the water taxi, now pursing his lips into a duck face, now leaning over the railing to lick a clear blue iceberg.

“These mountains, I’m gonna tell you, we’ve looked at them, quite frankly, and they’re not as high as the ones back home,” Mark Critch, a Canadian comedian, bleats in a convincing Trumpian cadence. “A lot of people say they’re not even mountains, they’re hills.”

Normally at this point in the tour, the Greenlandic guides answer travelers’ questions about the depth of the fjord and the settlement of about

GREENLAND, Page A10



Mark Critch, a Canadian comedian, did his best Trump impersonation as he filmed a segment of his show while riding a water taxi.

Who’ll win Grammy gold?

Kendrick Lamar, Lady Gaga, and Bad Bunny are among the top contenders for the evening’s highest honors. **SundayArts, N1.**

VOL. 309, NO. 32

Suggested retail price \$6.00

A little flaky

Sunday: Flurries. High: 24-29. Low: 12-17.
Monday: Warmer. High: 30-35. Low: 11-16.
High tide: 10:20 a.m. 11:01 p.m.
Sunrise: 6:58 Sunset: 4:58
Complete report, **C22.** Deaths, **C16-20.**

Club teams are a booming business in youth sports, but are they good for young athletes? **Globe Magazine.**

The Coast Guard called off the search for a fishing vessel and the people aboard, rekindling a familiar grief in Gloucester. **Metro, B1.**

Channeling her inner Trump, Leavitt has become a MAGA star

By Jim Puzzanghera and James Pindell
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Another overflow crowd packed the White House briefing room on a recent afternoon, dozens of independent journalists, bloggers, podcasters, and social media influencers squeezing into the narrow aisles straddling the 49 seats largely occupied by reporters from mainstream media.

As the temperature in the room rose, so did the anticipation for the arrival of Karoline

Leavitt, the 28-year-old New Hampshire native who became the youngest-ever White House press secretary a year ago. Since then, standing-room-only briefings — typically reserved for appearances by the president or special guests — have been the norm as Leavitt has turned into a MAGA star.

“Shut the door, there’s an infant in here,” somebody yelled after an attempt to cool things off with a blast of frigid air on Jan. 15, minutes before a briefing that demonstrated

LEAVITT, Page A8

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